PARTY POLITICS 1947–67: THE CONGRESS SYSTEM & THE OPPOSITION

THE 1948 BAN ON → THE TANDON-NEHRU CONTEST, 1950-51 → JANA SANGH, 1951, IS → KMPP, 1951, INTO THE → THE 1964 SPLIT IN → RAJNI KOTHARI'S 'CONGRESS SYSTEM'

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

THE 1948 BAN ON DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP

THE 1948 BAN ON DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP · CONGRESS CONSTITUTION · AMENDED 1948 · BARS DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP · CONGRESS SOCIALIST PARTY (CSP) MEMBERS INSIDE CONGRESS · FORCED CHOICE · REMAIN IN CONGRESS OR JOIN AN INDEPENDENT SOCIALIST PARTY · MOST CSP LEADERS EXIT; AN INDEPENDENT SOCIALIST PARTY IS

CORE CLAIM

- CONGRESS CONSTITUTION → amended 1948: BARS DUAL PARTY MEMBERSHIP
- TARGET → Congress Socialist Party (CSP) members inside Congress
- FORCED CHOICE → remain in Congress OR join an independent socialist party

MECHANISM

- RESULT → most CSP leaders exit: an INDEPENDENT SOCIALIST PARTY is formed
- CONSEQUENCE → the non-Communist Left's long history OUTSIDE Congress begins
- MUST REMEMBER: Congress dominance must be read beside the Socialist exit (1948), Bharatiya

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Jana Sangh (1951), KMPP-Socialist merger into the PSP (1952), Swatantra Party (1959), CPI split (1964) and the 1967 electoral watershed.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → most CSP leaders exit; an INDEPENDENT SOCIALIST PARTY is formed.

01

STAGE 01

THE TANDON-NEHRU CONTEST, 1950-51

THE TANDON-NEHRU CONTEST, 1950-51 · CONGRESS PRESIDENTIAL CONTEST · TANDON DEFEATS THE NEHRU-BACKED CANDIDATE · TANDON'S CONSERVATIVE-HINDU LEANINGS VS NEHRU'S SECULAR LINE · TANDON RESIGNS THE CONGRESS PRESIDENCY · NEHRU HIMSELF THEN TAKES OVER AS CONGRESS PRESIDENT · DO NOT REVERSE THIS ORDER OR COMPRESS IT INTO

1950 → CONGRESS PRESIDENTIAL CONTEST: Tandon defeats the Nehru-backed candidate → 1950-51 → friction: Tandon's conservative-Hindu leanings vs Nehru's secular line → 1951 → TANDON RESIGNS the Congress presidency → 1951 → NEHRU HIMSELF then takes over as Congress president → TRAP → do not reverse this order or compress it into a single year

CORE CLAIM

- 1950 → CONGRESS PRESIDENTIAL CONTEST: Tandon defeats the Nehru-backed candidate
- 1950-51 → friction: Tandon's conservative-Hindu leanings vs Nehru's secular line

MECHANISM

- 1951 → TANDON RESIGNS the Congress presidency
- 1951 → NEHRU HIMSELF then takes over as Congress president

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRAP → do not reverse this order or compress it into a single year
- 1950 → CONGRESS PRESIDENTIAL CONTEST: Tandon defeats the Nehru-backed candidate

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not reverse this order or compress it into a single year.

02

STAGE 02

JANA SANGH, 1951, IS NOT SWATANTRA, 1959

JANA SANGH, 1951, IS NOT SWATANTRA, 1959 · BHARATIYA JANA SANGH · FOUNDED 1951, FOUNDER SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE · ORGANISATIONAL LINKS TO THE RSS NETWORK (STATE THIS CAREFULLY) · HINDU-NATIONALIST CULTURAL-POLITICAL LINE · SWATANTRA PARTY · FOUNDED 1959, FOUNDERS RAJAGOPALACHARI · FREE-MARKET, ANTI-COLLECTIVISATION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BHARATIYA JANA SANGH → founded 1951, founder SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE	PLATFORM → Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line	PLATFORM → free-market, anti-collectivisation → a DIFFERENT right-of-Congress line
LINK → organisational links to the RSS network (state this carefully)	SWATANTRA PARTY → founded 1959, founders RAJAGOPALACHARI / MASANI / RANGA	BHARATIYA JANA SANGH → founded 1951, founder SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE

CORE CLAIM

- BHARATIYA JANA SANGH → founded 1951, founder SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE
- LINK → organisational links to the RSS network (state this carefully)

MECHANISM

- PLATFORM → Hindu-nationalist cultural-political line
- SWATANTRA PARTY → founded 1959, founders RAJAGOPALACHARI / MASANI / RANGA

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PLATFORM → free-market, anti-collectivisation → a DIFFERENT right-of-Congress line
- BHARATIYA JANA SANGH → founded 1951, founder SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PLATFORM → free-market, anti-collectivisation → a DIFFERENT right-of-Congress line.

03

STAGE 03

KMPP, 1951, INTO THE PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY, 1952

KMPP, 1951, INTO THE PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY, 1952 · KISAN MAZDOOR PRAJA PARTY (KMPP) FOUNDED, LED BY J.B. · KMPP MERGES WITH THE SOCIALIST PARTY · PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY (PSP) FORMED AS A RESULT · AFTER 1952 · THE PSP ITSELF SPLITS AND RE-FORMS REPEATEDLY THROUGH THE

1951 → KISAN MAZDOOR PRAJA PARTY (KMPP) founded, led by J.B. KRIPALANI → 1952 → KMPP MERGES WITH THE SOCIALIST PARTY → 1952 → PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY (PSP) formed as a result → AFTER 1952 → the PSP itself splits and re-forms repeatedly through the 1950s-60s

CORE CLAIM

- 1951 → KISAN MAZDOOR PRAJA PARTY (KMPP) founded, led by J.B. KRIPALANI
- 1952 → KMPP MERGES WITH THE SOCIALIST PARTY

MECHANISM

- 1952 → PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY (PSP) formed as a result
- AFTER 1952 → the PSP itself splits and re-forms repeatedly through the 1950s-60s

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 1951 → KISAN MAZDOOR PRAJA PARTY (KMPP) founded, led by J.B. KRIPALANI
- 1952 → KMPP MERGES WITH THE SOCIALIST PARTY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1952 → PRAJA SOCIALIST PARTY (PSP) formed as a result.

04

STAGE 04

THE 1964 SPLIT IN THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA

THE 1964 SPLIT IN THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA · EARLY 1960S · IDEOLOGICAL STRAIN · THE SINO-SOVIET SPLIT · SHARPENED BY · DIFFERING RESPONSES TO THE 1962 BORDER WAR · THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA SPLITS · CPI (ONE STREAM) AND THE NEW CPI(M)

CORE CLAIM

- EARLY 1960S → ideological strain: the Sino-Soviet split
- SHARPENED BY → differing responses to the 1962 border war

MECHANISM

- 1964 → THE COMMUNIST PARTY OF INDIA SPLITS
- RESULT → CPI (one stream) and the new CPI(M)

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → the organised Left enters the mid-1960s divided, not unified
- EARLY 1960S → ideological strain: the Sino-Soviet split

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → CPI (one stream) and the new CPI(M).

05

STAGE 05

RAJNI KOTHARI'S 'CONGRESS SYSTEM'

RAJNI KOTHARI'S 'CONGRESS SYSTEM' · RAJNI KOTHARI · POLITICAL SCIENTIST, COINS THE TERM "CONGRESS SYSTEM" · CONGRESS FUNCTIONS AS A "PARTY OF CONSENSUS", ABSORBING FACTIONS · OPPOSITION ROLE · PARTIES OF "PRESSURE", NOT ALTERNATIVE-GOVERNMENT CONTENDERS · KOTHARI'S ANALYTICAL TERM, NOT A CONGRESS SELF-DESCRIPTION · USE ONLY AS AN ANALYTICAL LENS ON THE EVIDENCE

RAJNI KOTHARI → political scientist, coins the term "CONGRESS SYSTEM"

CLAIM → Congress functions as a "PARTY OF CONSENSUS", absorbing factions internally → OPPOSITION ROLE → parties of "PRESSURE", not alternative-government contenders → ATTRIBUTION → Kothari's analytical term, NOT a Congress self-description

CORE CLAIM

- RAJNI KOTHARI → political scientist, coins the term "CONGRESS SYSTEM"
- CLAIM → Congress functions as a "PARTY OF CONSENSUS", absorbing factions internally

MECHANISM

- OPPOSITION ROLE → parties of "PRESSURE", not alternative-government contenders
- ATTRIBUTION → Kothari's analytical term, NOT a Congress self-description

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BOUNDARY → use only as an analytical lens on the evidence, never as fact-by-itself
- RAJNI KOTHARI → political scientist, coins the term "CONGRESS SYSTEM"

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → use only as an analytical lens on the evidence, never as fact-by-itself.

06

STAGE 06

SEAT MAJORITIES ON A MINORITY VOTE SHARE

SEAT MAJORITIES ON A MINORITY VOTE SHARE · CONGRESS SEAT RESULT · CONGRESS NATIONAL VOTE · COMFORTABLE MAJORITY · WELL UNDER 50 PER CENT · FIRST-PAST-THE-POST ARITHMETIC ACTING ON A FRAGMENTED OPPOSITION

YEAR	CONGRESS SEAT RESULT	CONGRESS NATIONAL VOTE
1952	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent
1957	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent
1962	comfortable majority	well under 50 per cent

CORE CLAIM

- CONGRESS SEAT RESULT
- CONGRESS NATIONAL VOTE

MECHANISM

- comfortable majority
- well under 50 per cent

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MECHANISM → first-past-the-post arithmetic acting on a fragmented opposition
- CONGRESS SEAT RESULT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: YEAR | CONGRESS SEAT RESULT | CONGRESS NATIONAL VOTE.

07

STAGE 07

THE PLURAL, FRAGMENTED INDIAN LEFT

THE PLURAL, FRAGMENTED INDIAN LEFT · PRO-SOVIET STREAM AFTER THE 1964 SPLIT · THE NEW FORMATION AFTER THE 1964 SPLIT · FORWARD BLOC · SMALLER FORMATIONS, STRONGEST IN BENGAL AND KERALA · KERALA, 1957 · THE ERA'S CLEAREST LEFT ELECTORAL SUCCESS (TOPIC 32) · READ IT CORRECTLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CPI → pro-Soviet stream after the 1964 split	RSP / FORWARD BLOC → smaller formations, strongest in Bengal and Kerala	READ IT CORRECTLY → "the Left" was NEVER a single unified bloc, 1947-67
CPI(M) → the new formation after the 1964 split	KERALA, 1957 → the era's clearest Left electoral success (topic 32)	CPI → pro-Soviet stream after the 1964 split

CORE CLAIM

- CPI → pro-Soviet stream after the 1964 split
- CPI(M) → the new formation after the 1964 split

MECHANISM

- RSP / FORWARD BLOC → smaller formations, strongest in Bengal and Kerala
- KERALA, 1957 → the era's clearest Left electoral success (topic 32)

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- READ IT CORRECTLY → "the Left" was NEVER a single unified bloc, 1947-67
- CPI → pro-Soviet stream after the 1964 split

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READ IT CORRECTLY → "the Left" was NEVER a single unified bloc, 1947-67.

08

STAGE 08

CONGRESS AS AN UMBRELLA, NOT A NARROW PARTY

CONGRESS AS AN UMBRELLA, NOT A NARROW PARTY · CONGRESS ORGANISATION · A BROAD UMBRELLA · NEHRUVIAN PLANNERS + CONSERVATIVE TRADITIONALISTS + REGIONAL BOSSES · FACTIONAL COMPETITION HAPPENS INSIDE CONGRESS, NOT MAINLY BETWEEN PARTIES · BY THE MID-1960S · STATE-LEVEL "SYNDICATE" BOSSES BECOME ORGANISATIONALLY DECISIVE · LINK FORWARD

CONGRESS ORGANISATION → a broad UMBRELLA

CONTAINS → Nehruvian planners + conservative traditionalists + regional bosses → MECHANISM → factional competition happens INSIDE Congress, not mainly between parties → BY THE MID-1960s → state-level "SYNDICATE" bosses become organisationally decisive

CORE CLAIM

- CONGRESS ORGANISATION → a broad UMBRELLA
- CONTAINS → Nehruvian planners + conservative traditionalists + regional bosses

MECHANISM

- MECHANISM → factional competition happens INSIDE Congress, not mainly between parties
- BY THE MID-1960s → state-level "SYNDICATE" bosses become organisationally decisive

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LINK FORWARD → this factionalism shapes the 1966 succession contest (topic 34)
- CONGRESS ORGANISATION → a broad UMBRELLA

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LINK FORWARD → this factionalism shapes the 1966 succession contest (topic 34).

09

STAGE 09

LOHIA'S 'NON-CONGRESSISM': A DOCTRINE AHEAD OF ITS TIME

LOHIA'S 'NON-CONGRESSISM' · A DOCTRINE AHEAD OF ITS TIME · RAM MANOHAR LOHIA · LEADING SOCIALIST FIGURE, CRITIC OF CONGRESS DOMINANCE · UNITE THE OPPOSITION AGAINST CONGRESS, DESPITE IDEOLOGY · LITTLE PRACTICAL ELECTORAL EFFECT · THE SAME LOGIC UNDERLIES THE JANATA COALITION (TOPIC 36) · DO NOT CLAIM NON-CONGRESSISM SUCCEEDED ELECTORALLY WITHIN THIS TOPIC'S

RAM MANOHAR LOHIA → leading Socialist figure, critic of Congress dominance → DOCTRINE → "NON-CONGRESSISM": unite the opposition against Congress, despite ideology → 1947-67 → little practical electoral effect → 1977 → the SAME logic underlies the Janata coalition (topic 36) → TRAP → do not claim non-Congressism succeeded electorally within this topic's period

CORE CLAIM

- RAM MANOHAR LOHIA → leading Socialist figure, critic of Congress dominance
- DOCTRINE → "NON-CONGRESSISM": unite the opposition against Congress, despite ideology
- 1947-67 → little practical electoral effect

MECHANISM

- 1977 → the SAME logic underlies the Janata coalition (topic 36)
- TRAP → do not claim non-Congressism succeeded electorally within this topic's period
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Rajni Kothari's "Congress system" meant competitive one-party dominance, not a one-party state: first-past-the-post converted sub-50-per-cent

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- vote shares into large seat majorities while opposition parties retained distinct socialist, communist, conservative and regional bases.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not claim non-Congressism succeeded electorally within this topic's period.

10

STAGE 10

THE OPPOSITION'S IDEOLOGICAL RANGE, 1947-67

THE OPPOSITION'S IDEOLOGICAL RANGE, 1947-67 · CORE POSITION · JANA SANGH (1951) · HINDU-NATIONALIST CULTURAL POLITICS · SWATANTRA (1959) · FREE-MARKET ECONOMIC CONSERVATISM · PSP AND STREAMS · NON-COMMUNIST SOCIALIST POLITICS

PARTY/STREAM	CORE POSITION
Jana Sangh (1951)	Hindu-nationalist cultural politics
Swatantra (1959)	free-market economic conservatism
PSP and streams	non-Communist socialist politics
CPI / CPI(M)	organised communism, split from 1964

CORE CLAIM

- CORE POSITION
- Jana Sangh (1951)
- Hindu-nationalist cultural politics
- Swatantra (1959)
- free-market economic conservatism

MECHANISM

- PSP and streams
- non-Communist socialist politics
- CPI / CPI(M)
- organised communism, split from 1964
- PROBLEM → real range, but FRAGMENTED, not unified, before 1967

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Election returns, party constitutions and manifestos, Tandon-Nehru organisational
- conflict and Kothari's attributed model must replace teleological claims that
- Congress dominance was either inevitable consensus or disguised dictatorship.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Congress dominance was either inevitable consensus or disguised dictatorship.

11

STAGE 11

1967: THE WATERSHED THIS WHOLE TOPIC FORESHADOWS

THE WATERSHED THIS WHOLE TOPIC FORESHADOWS · BAN, SPLITS, MERGERS, NEW PARTIES RESHAPE THE OPPOSITION · CONGRESS SEAT MAJORITY STAYS LARGE; VOTE SHARE KEEPS DECLINING · CPI SPLITS INTO CPI/CPI(M) · FOR THE FIRST TIME, CONGRESS LOSES POWER IN EIGHT · READ THE THREAD · 1967 IS THE PAYOFF OF TWO DECADES OF PARTY-SYSTEM

1948–1964 → ban, splits, mergers, new parties reshape the opposition → 1952 / 1957 / 1962 → Congress SEAT majority stays large; VOTE SHARE keeps declining → 1964 → CPI splits into CPI/CPI(M) → 1967 → for the FIRST TIME, Congress loses power in EIGHT STATES → READ THE THREAD → 1967 is the payoff of two decades of party-system change

CORE CLAIM

- 1948-1964 → ban, splits, mergers, new parties reshape the opposition
- 1952 / 1957 / 1962 → Congress SEAT majority stays large; VOTE SHARE keeps declining

MECHANISM

- 1964 → CPI splits into CPI/CPI(M)
- 1967 → for the FIRST TIME, Congress loses power in EIGHT STATES

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- READ THE THREAD → 1967 is the payoff of two decades of party-system change
- 1948-1964 → ban, splits, mergers, new parties reshape the opposition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READ THE THREAD → 1967 is the payoff of two decades of party-system change.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · CHANDRA STRESSES THAT CONGRESS WAS TRANSFORMED FROM A MOVEMENT · PLURAL, CONSENSUAL, IDEOLOGICALLY FLEXIBLE CHARACTER — A "PARTY OF · FOLLOWING RAJNI KOTHARI, THE SYSTEM HAD A MECHANISM OF · FACTIONS INSIDE CONGRESS · PERFORMED THE FUNCTION AN OPPOSITION WOULD, WHILE EXTERNAL PARTIES · THE PARTY-VS-GOVERNMENT QUESTION (KRIPALANI'S DEMAND THAT THE ORGANISATION CONTROL · IN FAVOUR OF GOVERNMENTAL RESPONSIBILITY TO THE LEGISLATURE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Chandra stresses that Congress was transformed from a movement into a party yet retained a
- plural, consensual, ideologically flexible character — a "party of the centre" with a left orientation.
- CAUTION: Following Rajni Kothari, the system had a mechanism of consensus and dissent : factions inside Congress
- performed the function an opposition would, while external parties acted as "parties of pressure" that Congress absorbed.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- The party-vs-government question (Kripalani's demand that the organisation control the government) was settled
- in favour of governmental responsibility to the legislature , concentrating authority around Nehru.
- CAUTION: The system's genius was co-optation : Congress adopted the popular planks
- of its rivals (socialism, land reform, backward-class welfare), denying them space.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- The Socialists/PSP were paralysed by the choice between Asoka Mehta's cooperation and
- Lohia's militant anti-Congressism , and drained by defections back to Congress.
- The CPI's oscillation — insurrection (Ranadive, 1948–51) → parliamentary path (Ajoy Ghosh) → 1964
- split — reflected an unresolved dispute over the class character of the Indian state.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels